14.10.4.1 Step 1: Create a New Laravel 12 Project

Open your terminal and create a new Laravel project:

```
laravel new hello-api
cd hello-api
code .
```

You should see the Laravel project structure in your code editor.

14.10.4.2 Step 2: Enable API Support in Laravel 12

Laravel 12 **does not enable API routing by default**. Activate API support by running:

```
php artisan install:api
```

This command:

✔ Creates the `routes/api.php` file
✔ Configures **middleware** for API authentication
✔ Installs Laravel Sanctum (optional for authentication)

14.10.4.3 Step 3: Create a Controller for API Logic

We will create a controller to handle the API logic. Run the following command to generate a controller:

```
php artisan make:controller HelloController
```

Now, open `app/Http/Controllers/HelloController.php` and update it with the following code:

```php
<?php

namespace App\Http\Controllers;

use Illuminate\Http\Request;
use Illuminate\Http\JsonResponse;

class HelloController extends Controller
{
    // GET: Return a welcome message with timestamp
    public function getMessage(): JsonResponse
    {
        return response()->json([
            'message' => 'Hello World from GET!',
            'timestamp' => now()->toDateTimeString()
        ], 200);
    }

    // POST: Accept input and return a message
    public function postMessage(Request $request): JsonResponse
```